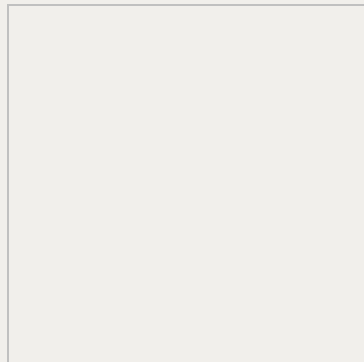


IN PROFILE

Study with Sechter

Although a fluent composer in his young adult years, Bruckner became convinced that he still had much to learn about musical technique. In 1855, he began a correspondence course in counterpoint with Simon Sechter (1788–1867), a Vienna-based tutor. The course ended in 1861, with Sechter awarding his pupil a glowing testimonial; and Sechter was among the judges when Bruckner applied for a teaching diploma from Vienna Conservatory—he passed with flying colors. Another panel member, the conductor Joseph Herbeck, commented: “He should have examined us! If I knew one tenth of what he knows, I’d be happy.”



LITHOGRAPH OF SIMON SECHTER, AGED 52, 1840

Anton Bruckner was born in the small Upper Austrian village of Ansfelden, near the city of Linz. His father was the village schoolmaster and a part-time musician and organist; his mother had sung in the village church choir. He was the oldest of 11 children, several of whom died in infancy.